

out the window bar, etc.). The “automatic timer delay” allows screen capture at preset time intervals.

Versatility, many useful tools, and a small footprint make IrfanView undoubtedly a most essential software.

6.4 K-Lite Mega Codec Pack

One can find hundreds of codecs for audio and video, but K-Lite Mega Codec Pack, like its name suggests, is a bundle of codecs of various types, both audio and video bundled together.

It is actually a compilation of three codec packs—K-Lite Codec Pack Full, QuickTime Alternative, and Real Alternative. QuickTime Alternative allows one to play files without having to install the QuickTime Player. Files such as .mov, .3gp, .qt, and streaming content from Web pages run under QuickTime. Similarly, with Real Alternative, one can do away with RealPlayer for playing RealAudio (.ra, .rpm), RealMedia (.rm, .ram, .rpx, .smi), RealText (.rt), and RealPix (.rp). K-Lite plays all these file types and many more using codecs through a Windows Media Player like interface called Media Player Classic. This player plays DVDs with real-time zoom and subtitle support.

K-Lite has many tools that will help one with encoding audio or video files. Bitrate Calculator is a tool that allows one to calculate the approximate size of a media file when converted to the XviD format. This is useful when you want to encode a media file—for example .dat or .vox—to the XviD AVI so as to fit it in a CD.

GraphEdit is another tool in K-Lite Codec Pack. It is the best way to extract audio from a DVD. Dragging and drop-



Extract DVD audio using GraphEdit